

modernizr.com/download. You have an option to download the production version (small in size, loads fast) or the development version (large in size, good for learning).

Assuming that the downloaded file is modernizr.custom.34635.js and it is stored in the js folder of your website; install it on a webpage by using a script tag in the head area of your page. That's it! Your 'Modernizr-ready' source code will look something like:

```
<!doctype html>
<html><head>
<script src="js/ modernizr.custom.34635"></script>
</head><!-- other stuff here... -->
</html>
```

Installed, what next?

Once the library is installed in a webpage, it is ready for feature test & detection.

Modernizr runs quickly on page load to test and detect features; it then creates a JavaScript object with the results, and also adds classes to the html element for you to key your CSS on.

The 'live' html element for the webpage, when viewed in the latest Chrome browser, might look something like:

```
<html class="js flexbox no-touch hashchange history rgba multiplebgs backgroundsize borderradius boxshadow textshadow opacity cssanimations css-columns cssgradients csstransforms csstransitions fontface generatedcontent video">
```

Google Chrome supports variable opacity, as prescribed by the CSS3 specification; hence, the class 'opacity' is dynamically inserted inside the html element. Chrome for desktops usually does not support 'touch', hence the prefix 'no-' is included with the term 'touch' here.

Assume that we have a 'div' element in the body with its id set to 'mycoolbox'. We can write its CSS styling in the following manner:

```
#mycoolbox {
height : 252px;
width : 252px;
}
.no-opacity #mycoolbox {
/* used when browser doesn't support opacity */
background-color : rgb(10, 87, 110);
}
.opacity #mycoolbox {
/* used when browser supports opacity */
background-color : rgb(60, 137, 160);
opacity : 0.2;
}
```

These CSS definitions will make the 'opacity supporting browsers' render the 'mycoolbox' div with 20% opacity. In browsers that don't support opacity, the 'no-opacity' class will induce a new 'mimicking' colour!

*pointers

>>Nuggets of cool code at work



*Modernizr with Faruk Ates

>>Faruk Ates, one the creators behind Modernizr is going to tell you what it is, what it does, and why you should use it.

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<http://dvwx.in/OTNMRw>



*Modernizr's test suite: Behind the Scenes

>>Paul Irish shares how he built the Modernizr test suite: caniuse, jsonselect, detect-global, qunit, jquery deferreds, github.js.

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<http://dvwx.in/UHJH8g>



*Zuckerberg on Facebook, and more

>>Facebook CEO Mark Zuckerberg talks to TechCrunch founder Michael Arrington at TechCrunch Disruptive.

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<http://dvwx.in/Qt48EW>



*Fast UIs for cross device web

>> Boris Smus talks on web sites that support multiple device form factors, discusses single page sites and some of the layout features in modern mobile browsers.

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<http://dvwx.in/QaVD1p>

In addition to modifying the html element, Modernizr also creates a JavaScript object, simply called Modernizr, which has a list of Boolean-valued properties for each individual tested feature.

For example, If the browser supports 'touch', the Modernizr object will contain a Modernizr.touch property with its Boolean value set to true.

To make use of possible support for 'touch' in a browser, you can write conditional JavaScript statements like:

```
if (Modernizr.touch) [
//code that has something to do with touch capability
]
else [
//code to handle the unavailability of touch capability
]
```

Similarly, other browser capabilities can be harnessed using such JavaScript conditional statements. Have a look at Modernizr's documentation at <http://modernizr.com/docs/> to get the complete list of features tested by Modernizr.

Popular websites like css-tricks.com, about.com and posterous.com among many others use Modernizr to selectively deliver HTML5 and CSS3 content to its users. If you use a debugger like FireBug, you should take a sneak peek at their live source code to witness the 'live Modernizr action'.

Is that it?

We apologize if we kept you waiting for the 'Internet Explorer modernizing' thing! Nevertheless, this feature is certainly worth the wait!

Modernizr comes bundled with something called HTML5 Shiv, which provides you the capability to render basic HTML5 elements in IE browsers! It will add HTML5 and CSS3 support in Internet explorer browsers; while you need to make sure that you do include HTML5 Shiv while building your Modernizr download package!

So, should I use it?

If you choose to code your webpages in a layered manner, and you don't intend very strict uniformity in the layout across every browser you wish to target, you should seriously consider using Modernizr in your projects.

All said and done, Modernizr is hands down the best tool out there, which can save you hundreds of geek-hours, if you do care to give your users the best of both the worlds with great browser-support and experience, without sacrificing the goodness of the new and shiny features of CSS3 and HTML5! >

Read the original article online on devworx. Visit www.devworx.in